THE SPOILS OF HISTORY

PODCAST

With a web series in the works, a popular podcast in its third season and a new book wrapped up, **William Dalrymple** *is in a happy place*



How exactly did a provincial trading company end up becoming the most dominant political and economic force in the Indian subcontinent? What set of circumstances in the late Mughal era allowed the East India Company to take over, well, everything in India? These are the kinds of questions historian William Dalrymple's 2019 work of nonfiction *The Anarchy* (Bloomsbury Publishing) seeks to answer.

The bestselling book, which was nominated for the Bailie Gifford Prize (and included in former US President Barack Obama's annual 'Books of the Year' list), will soon be adapted into a web series by producer Siddharth Roy Kapur's Roy Kapur Productions. Screenwriter Jeremy Brock (*The Last King of Scotland*, *Brideshead Revisited*) will adapt the book while Dalrymple himself will be a consultant.

Talking about the book and its cinematic potential, Dalrymple says, "It really is the most remarkable story. One company from a tiny island on the other side of the world eventually took over as the government of India, taking loans from Indian banks. At one point, the head offices in India had only a few hundred Englishmen. I wanted to write about this vivid set of charac-

Dalrymple's greatest strength is to make history accessible to the lay reader—both **The Anarchy** and **Empire** help him do that